

Second Edition

The Essential Guide to Internet Marketing

Key Strategies for
Web Marketing
Success

[CloudTactix Interactive]



Introduction

If you're reading this ebook, chances are you're either a marketing professional or a business owner who understands the importance of internet marketing today. You understand that traditional marketing methods—though expensive—are growing ineffective in an increasingly online marketplace. By neglecting to market your business on the web, you're missing out on the powerful results an effective internet marketing strategy can yield. Whether you're just getting started in internet marketing, or you're a seasoned professional looking to brush up on the basics, this ebook can serve as your step-by-step guide to implementing an effective plan of action. From establishing a keyword strategy, to utilizing social media to promote content, to analyzing and refining an overall online marketing strategy, this comprehensive ebook will guide you through the steps necessary to effectively marketing your business on the web.



1

Creating a Keyword Strategy



What is a Keyword?

A keyword is a word or phrase that gets entered into a search engine like Google or Bing, or a social media site like Facebook, LinkedIn, or Twitter. If you want to boil internet marketing down to a single starting point, keywords are it.

Why Build a Keyword Strategy?

More and more consumers are finding businesses online through search engines. How do they find them? Keywords. You can take advantage of this consumer practice by optimizing your website around the specific keywords relevant to your business. When optimized, your business will stand a better chance of being found by consumers using search engines and social media to search for your keywords, driving increased and better quality traffic to your website.

While it may be difficult to know initially which keywords will drive the most relevant consumers to your website, there are ways to determine the popularity and competitiveness of specific keywords. Similarly, you can test and analyze how effective specific keywords are at drawing visitors to your site.

As a business professional, you should make sure the right people are finding your business online. In this section, you will learn how to specify the keywords which will maximize your site's relevant traffic via search engines.

Keyword research is a continuing process that should be monitored closely—doing so will provide valuable insight into industry trends and product demand. Comprehensive keyword research can help a business to greatly increase its organic traffic, and save you from unnecessary spending on payper-click (PPC) campaigns like Google Adwords.



How to Create a Keyword Strategy

- 1.** Create a list of 3-5 keywords relevant to your business. Put yourself in your potential customers' shoes. What keywords would they use to search for your business?
- 2.** Select keywords that are 'specific' and 'relevant.'
The more often a keyword is typed into a search engine, the more competitive it becomes. General keywords like “marketing” and “business” are highly competitive, meaning it would be very difficult for a business to rank high in search engine results for those keywords. A small- or medium-sized business should choose less-competitive keywords—keywords specific to your individual business (commonly referred to as “long tail” keywords).

Similarly, choose keywords that are relevant to your business. Certain obscure terms might yield your business a higher search engine ranking, but you risk drawing ineffective leads rather than consumers genuinely interested in your specific products/services.

Find a balance between specificity and relevance. Choose 5 or so keywords that define what your business does. Remember, these keywords aren't set-in-stone. You can test other keywords to see which work best for your business. (We'll explore this in more depth in Chapter 8, Analyzing & Re-fining Strategies.)

- 3.** Design and optimize your website around your keywords. Now that you've chosen your keywords, it's time to incorporate them into your site. We'll explain how in the following chapter—Chapter 2, Optimizing Your Website.



2

Optimizing Your Website



Once you've chosen your keywords, you can begin to raise your website's search engine ranking. This is called 'Search Engine Optimization' (SEO). In order for your business to be found online, your website should appear on the first few pages of your keywords' search engine results. Google suggests you design your website for visitors—not search engines. And while this principle is worth keeping in mind, SEO techniques should be implemented in order to better optimize your site.

What You Should Know About SEO

SEO can be divided into two categories: 'on-page SEO' and 'off-page SEO'. On-page SEO refers to how well your website's content is presented to search engines. Off-page SEO refers to your site's overall "authority" on the web, which is determined by what other websites say about your site. You will likely need to devote more time and effort to your website's Off-page SEO—but don't be discouraged: the payoff can be dramatic.

Even though it only accounts for roughly one-quarter of your website's search engine ranking, you should attend to On-page SEO first because it can be improved quickly.

Page titles are one of the most important on-page SEO factors. Page titles are the text you see at the top of your browser window when viewing a web page. They are also the title of a page that is presented in search engines.

The Nine Elements of Successful On-Page SEO

1. Page Title

Page titles can be found and edited in your site's HTML. Your page title is the text inside the <title> tags—for example, <title>Your Page Title</title>



The following are a few guidelines for coming up with effective page titles:

- Include keywords.
- Make it fewer than 70 characters long. Longer page titles will not be seen in your web browser or in Google search results. If you make the page title too long, it will also dilute the importance of the keywords mentioned.
- Put keywords as close to the beginning of the title as possible.
- Make it readable for site visitors.
- Include your company name at the end of the page title, unless you are a big brand and people search for you through your brand name.
- Use a different page title for each page. Each page is an opportunity to target different keywords.

2. Meta Description

Meta data is the plain text description that appears just beneath the page title in a Google search, and an often overlooked opportunity to attract visitors from a search engine.

Meta description isn't actually visible on your web page, but rather appears as a short summary of the web page (150 characters or less) in a <meta description> tag near the top of the page's HTML source code.

Even though meta data does not directly influence search engine rankings, it's good practice to include keywords in your site's meta description. Relevant keywords can attract attention, potentially drawing in new visitors. And, if a meta description is altogether



excluded from the source code, the search engine will often display content from the page in its place.

Because it's a generally misunderstood element of page design, people tend to underutilize meta description when developing their websites.

3. Headings

Usually, your headings are pieces of text that appear larger or more prominent on a page than other text. Verify this by checking your site's HTML code. Does the text appear between the tags `<h1>`, `<h2>`, and/or `<h3>`? (Ask a web developer for assistance if needed.)

These headings are more likely to be read by search engines as keywords than text on the rest of the page. Therefore, include keywords in your headings whenever possible. The `<h1>` tag imbues text with more weight as a keyword than the `<h2>` tag, and the `<h2>` tag more weight than the `<h3>` tag. While `<h4>` and `<h5>` tags do exist, their influence on keywords is virtually the same as that of regular text.

Including too many headings dilutes the importance of keywords in other headings, so we recommend using the `<h1>` tag only once. If the page is textheavy, like a blog post, feel free to include a few `<h2>` or `<h3>` tags as your paragraph titles.

4. Cascading Style Sheets (CSC)

HTML is the back-end code of your website that search engines read. Search engines extract relevant information from your HTML, such as keywords.

Cascading Style Sheets, on the other hand, hold a template for the layout of your page. In the CSS, you define how headings, links, and other visual elements of the text should look.

The takeaway here is simple: use CSS. Putting layout-related information in your HTML can dilute the relevance of the HTML text, which is what you want search engines to read.



5. Images

Images on a web page can certainly enhance user experience. However, when inserting images into your website, you should keep in mind the following:

- Don't use images excessively. More pictures means your page will take longer to load. This has a negative impact on both user experience and search engine optimization.
- Associate text with pictures. Search engines do not 'read' images; they read only text. ALT text is an HTML attribute you can add to your picture so search engines replace the image with some associated text.
- Include keywords in your image file name. This will help you draw in relevant traffic from image searches. Separate different keywords in the file name with a dash (-).

6. Domain Info

Search engine rankings favor sites that are registered for a longer period of time. Longer domain registrations indicate a commitment to the site and mean the site has a lower chance of being spam. Extend your website registration for \$10-20 a year for an SEO boost.

7. MOZ Rank

MOZ Rank is a general measure of your site's online authority. The higher the MOZ Rank, the better. Note: Your MOZ rank factors into both your website's on-page and off-page SEO. Improving your on-page SEO may help improve your ranking, but this is only the beginning. (Don't worry, we'll get to that.)



8. Google Crawl Date

When Google crawls your website, it updates the information related to it, like keywords and other SEO factors. Thus, you want Google to crawl your site as often as possible.

How do you get Google to crawl your site more often? You need to produce fresh content and publish it regularly on your site. We'll cover this in more depth in Chapter 3, *Creating a Blog & Other Content*.

9. URL Structure

A URL is a web page's web address. All the pages of a website are connected through the site's URL structure. Unfortunately, improving your website's URL structure can be one of the most demanding aspects of on-page SEO. The methods for fixing these issues depend entirely on your website's back-end—its content management system or programming framework. Nevertheless, if you have a good developer on your side, tackling these issues can significantly improve your site's SEO. You might even hand your developer the following list.

The Nine Elements of Successful On-Page SEO

- **Apply a 301 redirect where required.** A 301 redirect forwards an old URL to a new one after it changes. Make sure to do this if you change the URL of a page on your site. A common mistake is not applying a 301 redirect between `yoursite.com` and `www.yoursite.com`. This can be a big detriment to your site's search engine ranking, because search engines will give separate credit to both versions.

Avoid pages with deeply nested URLs. Here is an example of what a deeply nested URL would look like:

- o `http://yoursite.com/about/management/contact/phone`.
Deeply nested pages will get less SEO credit. You can fix this problem by improving your overall site design.



- Include keywords in your URLs. If you've already purchased your main URL, don't worry about buying a new one. But you should modify—and cleanup—your website's interior page URLs to include keywords.
- For your internal page URLs, separate individual keywords with dashes (-). For example :
www.cloudtactix.com/inbound-marketing-solutions is a good URL that captures 'inbound' and 'marketing' and 'solutions' as keywords.

Create static URLs, not dynamic ones. This means that each page of your site should have only one URL, no matter what. Check to see if there are different URLs for the same page. If so, look into how to create static URLs using your web server software. Do a Google search for “create static URL” + *your server software*.

Avoid 'Keyword Stuffing'

At this point you may be thinking, “If keywords are so important to my site's search engine ranking, shouldn't I just fill each page entirely with keywords.”

Unfortunately, it's not that easy. Keyword stuffing compromises your content, leading to a poor experience for site visitors. In addition, search engines have gotten really good at detecting and adapting for this kind of behavior. Neither sacrificing readability nor trying to 'trick' search engines are sound SEO strategies.



Improving Off-Page SEO With Inbound Links

So if on-page SEO accounts for 25% of your overall search engine ranking, what makes up the remaining 75%? As we mentioned before, off-page SEO is based on the authority of your website, or what other websites ‘say’ about yours. Put simply, websites with greater authority will receive a higher ranking than websites with lesser authority.

The number and quality of your website’s ‘inbound links’ are some of the most important influences to your site’s authority. If another website links to your website—for instance, via a blog post—that is called an ‘inbound link.’ The more inbound links you have, the better; but, your website should also be linked to websites with greater authority themselves. (An inbound link from The New York Times website would be quite a bit more valuable than one from a low-traffic blog with a small readership.)

So, what’s the best way to acquire more inbound links? Content creation! Creating valuable, remarkable content that other websites will want to link to by way of their own content is a great way to increase your website’s inbound links. Furthermore, you can improve your chances of attracting a greater number of inbound links by sharing your content through social media, while optimizing your content for search engines. We’ll be discussing content creation in further depth in Chapter 3 (Creating Blogs & Other Content) and social media promotion in Chapter 4 (Promoting Content & Participating in Social Media).



3

Creating a Blog & Other Content



The emergence of blogging platforms like WordPress, Blogger, and Hubspot have made publishing content on the web the easiest it's ever been. Now that you've specified your business' keywords and optimized your website for search engines, your next step should be to create a blog, as well as other content like ebooks and webinars, as these are all powerful tools to attract the right visitors to your website.

Why a Blog?

Adding a blog automatically makes your website more dynamic by regularly infusing it with fresh content. Search engines reward stronger rankings to websites that consistently add fresh content, thus leading to more visitors and potential leads.

Blogging Platforms to Consider

WordPress, TypePad, Drupal, and Posterous are all blogging platforms that offer a content management system (CMS), which allows you, the publisher, to add content to your blog without having to be familiar with HTML coding.

Key Components of a Great Blog Post

A well-constructed blog post should include several key components:

- **An Attention-Grabbing Article Title:** The title of your blog article is the first thing people will see. Make sure it clearly indicates what your article is about. Make it concise, attention-grabbing, and keyword-rich (the header tag is the most important for SEO).
- **Well-Written & Formatted Text:** The body of your article should be well-written and in an easy-to-read format. Consider using header tags and bulleted lists to break up content into sections.



- **Images/Videos:** Relevant multimedia content can make a blog article memorable and more fun to read. It can also help break up text to make it more eye-pleasing.
- **Links:** Include in-text links to relevant content. These can also route visitors to landing pages, helping to generate leads. (We'll discuss 'landing pages' in Chapter 5, Converting Site Traffic Into Leads.)
- **Call-to-Action:** Each blog article you publish should include a relevant 'call-to-action' at the bottom of the article to help generate leads. (Covered in Chapter 5.)

What Should You Blog About?

For this you're going to have to take off your 'business owner' or 'marketing manager' hat and try thinking instead for a moment like a magazine publisher. What are your industry's emerging trends or issues? In what ways would you like to educate a potential customer or client?

Rather than writing about your products or services directly, a blog article should be about issues common to your industry, and the problems your potential customers face that your service seeks to solve.

In getting started, brainstorm the 10 most common questions you're asked by prospective customers. Then for each question write a short article that gives the answer. Post one article a week for ten weeks, and you've got a strong foundation for a successful blog.

Because your blog will perhaps be less formal than the other parts of your website, don't be afraid to let your passion and expertise shine through. This is the place to be yourself.



Converting Visitors Into Leads

In Chapter 5, we'll discuss how to create 'landing pages' and calls-to-action (CTAs) to drive potential customers to your business. Remember that your blog is an important conversion opportunity. Place a call-to-action at the end of every blog post. (CTAs work best if they're closely related to the article's subject matter.) In addition, you can place image-based CTAs in the sidebar of your blog as a secondary way of converting visitors into leads. A call-toaction should link directly to a landing page that offers access to a more indepth learning experience, such as a downloadable ebook or a webinar, upon completion of a lead generation form. We'll cover CTAs and landing pages in more depth in Chapter 5.

Other Content

While blogging is a great place to start, it isn't the only kind of content you can create. Consider producing longer-form content like ebooks, white papers, or research reports that can be offered to visitors in return for completing a lead generation form. Also, consider non-text offers such as 'how-to' videos, webinars, slideshows, and similar types of content.



4

Promoting Content & Participating in Social Media



Social media is getting a lot of buzz amongst marketing professionals and business owners these days. Marketers who can leverage social media to distribute content and grow a community of advocates stand to yield significant growth. Social media allows customers to communicate directly with your business, and supports the rapid spread of content online. Though new social media tools are frequently launched, most businesses most likely only need to focus on the major players: Facebook, Twitter, and LinkedIn.

Monitoring Social Media

You need to keep an eye on the online discussions related to your industry, and you need to know how, when necessary, to respond. Here are a few great tools to help you monitor your business and industry mentions in social media:

- **Google Alerts:** Set up a Google Alert each for your company, brand, product(s), and industry terms and leaders, etc. These alerts will be delivered directly to your email inbox at the frequency you indicate (e.g. daily or as they happen). Google Alerts are a great way to track mentions of your brand and relevant keywords on the web through news sites, blogs, etc.
- **Twitter:** Monitor mentions of your brand on Twitter with tools like Twitter Search or HootSuite. CoTweet is another great tool for managing multiple users on a corporate Twitter account, and allows you to assign specific tweets to appropriate team members for follow-up.
- **Google Reader and RSS Feeds:** Set up RSS feeds in Google Reader for searches of your brand or industry keywords in similar social media sites such as Flickr, Digg, and Delicious, etc. Scan the results for mentions, daily.
- **Facebook Insights:** Monitor and participate in discussions occurring on your company's Facebook Fan Page. Use your Fan Page's Facebook Insights Dashboard (found in the left



sidebar when signed in as an admin) to see stats such as 'fan growth' or 'page views' in order to gauge the interaction and engagement of your page.

Getting Started with Twitter

Twitter is a social network on which users share short, 140-character messages with each other. Users "follow" or subscribe to each other and can receive messages from each other via multiple technology devices including desktop computers, smart phones, and text messages. As mentioned previously, for business, it is best to use Twitter's free search engine, Twitter Search to search for your business, competitors, and industry mentions on Twitter. Understanding how and if people are talking about your business and industry will give you enough information to determine if you should invest the time to start and manage a Twitter account for your business.

If you decide that Twitter is right for your business, you can visit [Twitter.com](https://twitter.com) to sign up for a free account. Here are a few tips for setting up a business Twitter account:

- Use the name of your business as your Twitter username.
- Use your business logo or a picture of the person managing the account as the profile image for the account.
- Create a custom Twitter background that provides additional information about your business.
- Use Advanced Twitter Search to help determine industry influencers and potential customers that your business should follow.





Using Facebook for Business

With more than 500 million users, Facebook has become the major player in the social media industry. Facebook can serve as a powerful platform for building a community of advocates for your business to help increase word-of-mouth marketing. The first step in leveraging Facebook for business is to set up a business page.

LinkedIn: The Social Network for Business Professionals

The social network businesspeople may be most familiar with is LinkedIn. This network of over 101 million business users and more than 1 million business profile pages can be an important resource. To get started using LinkedIn for your business, it is best to set up and complete a personal profile for yourself as well as a company profile for your business. When setting up these profiles, remember to include all important information such as your website and blog URLs. Additionally, it is important to take the time to make the descriptions for you and your business interesting to read and an accurate reflection of your experience, knowledge, and passion.

LinkedIn Groups

Once you have created profiles, LinkedIn has two major features that are of particular use to businesses and their employees. The first feature you should examine is the Groups feature. The Groups feature allows LinkedIn users to create and participate in discussions around a topic within LinkedIn. Groups can be a great way to make potential business connections, but can also be a great place to share relevant blog content.

LinkedIn Answers

The second feature, LinkedIn Answers, allows you to find people publicly stating they have a specific problem or need that your product or service would solve. Identifying these questions and responding with a resource or a blog article of yours that answers that person's need can offer a great marketing opportunity for your business. Ultimately, you can generate high-quality traffic to your blog from LinkedIn Answers, and get some really qualified leads as well.



5

Converting Site Traffic Into Leads



By now, you should have already launched your blog, optimized your site for search engines, and started participating and promoting your content via social media. If it's been several weeks, you should already start to see a spike in traffic to your website.

There's only one problem. All that traffic to your site isn't leading to any new business! People are visiting your site, but those visits aren't leading to new customers—or even new sales leads.

So what do you do?

Simple. **Focus on conversion.** Focus on converting more of your website visitors into sales leads. To do this, decide on a compelling offer for your customers, create a call-to-action to promote your offer, and launch a landing page with a form for visitors to submit their information to obtain the offer. Finally, test, measure, and iterate the whole process.

Here's a detailed guide to each step in this sales and marketing conversion funnel:





Step 1: Decide on Your Offer

The offer is the most important part of any campaign. It's the initial attraction that catches the attention of your website visitors and gives them a reason to fill out the form used to collect their information. Your offer should target the type of sales lead you're trying to attract. For example, if you're a golf instructor, you want to create offers that will appeal to golfers trying to improve their game. If you're a sales process consultant, you'll want to create offers that appeal to executives trying to improve their sales process.

Typical content offers include research reports, how-to ebooks, slide downloads, or archived webinars. Other offers might include a free trial or demo of your product or a personal consultation. Of course, there's no reason to be constrained by what's typical. Use anything you think will work for your target customers. (Also keep in mind that the offer form is a conversation starter for the sales team, so it should be designed to start a conversation that will lead to a sale.)

Step 2: Create Calls-to-Action

Once you decide on your offer, create a few compelling CTAs. As we alluded to in Chapter 3, a call-to-action is a button or a link on a website that grabs a user's attention and directs that user to a landing page. On the landing page, the user is prompted to complete a form and submit contact information in order to receive what's being offered. By submitting that information, the visitor is then converted into a lead with whom your sales team can follow up. Your call-to-action can be text, an image, or html, but it should always include a link to the corresponding landing page. If you have an effective call-to-action, you'll convert a high percentage of your website visitors into leads.

Step 3: Create Landing Pages

After you create a call-to-action, you need to set up the landing page that it will link to. The landing page is the page where your website visitors arrive after they click on your call-to-action, and where they will fill out the form to receive your offer. You'd be surprised by how many times we've seen calls-to-action that aren't links. Whether



intentional or a matter of forgetfulness, the lack of a link will make it much harder for visitors to find out how to receive the offer, and they'll likely give up. So double, triple, and quadruple check to make sure all of your CTAs link to their corresponding landing pages.

As we said, landing pages house the form where users submit information that allows them to access your offer. The information you collect will also be used by you or your sales team to follow up with them. Once users submit their information on the landing page, they should be redirected to a 'thank-you' page where they can access the offer. (Note that if you're doing a promotion on a third party site—Google AdWords, for example—a landing page might be the first page on your site where your users arrive.)

Be crystal clear about what the offer is in your CTA. And be specific. If you're giving away a free guide, say "Download our FREE guide to X." If you're hosting a free webinar, say "Register for our FREE webinar on X." X should clearly convey a compelling benefit of receiving the offer. This is much more effective than "Download Now" or "Get a Free Article." These simply aren't specific enough.

Step 4: Test, Measure & Iterate

Offers, calls-to-action and landing pages are the core elements of the conversion process, but you can't stop there. If you just have a single conversion pathway, you have very little insight into the process and the way it performs. In order to improve your conversion process, you need to experiment. You need to test different CTAs, you need to test different landing pages, you need to test different offers, and then you need to decide which ones best help you achieve your goals.

After a CTA has been on your homepage for a month, vary the message or swap out an entirely new CTA, and after another month, measure which has been the best performer. If landing page conversions are low, move the form above the fold and measure the results. Don't be afraid to test different variations; you can always switch back if the old version worked better. It will be worth it when you've found the best combination that increases your site's conversions.



6

Nurturing Leads With Email Marketing



According to MarketingSherpa, 70% of your leads will end up buying something from you or one of your competitors, but they won't do it right away! Companies that build relationships with their leads over time have the greatest success in turning leads into customers by staying top-of-mind until the lead is ready to buy.

Lead nurturing is the process of developing that relationship with your potential customer by sending targeted, relevant, and valuable messages to them in a timely manner. The end goal is to get your leads to "raise their hand" and selfselect into further engaging with your business. Forrester Research found that companies that excel at lead nurturing are able to generate 50% more salesready leads at 33% lower cost-per-lead.

Email Marketing Best Practices

List-Building

- Create opt-in opportunities. Make sure your lead forms allow your website visitors to enter their email address and opt-in to receive your messages.
- Give people a reason to opt-in. Whether it's a landing page for an ebook or an email newsletter subscription form, make sure you give people a compelling reason to opt-in. What's so valuable about your ebook? What interesting and unique information will they receive in your email newsletter? Be explicit and phrase the benefit(s) in terms of your recipient.
- Would I be upset if I didn't receive your message? Only send messages to people who have explicitly opted in. You can follow the extreme principle of Seth Godin's Permission Marketing: Would your recipient be upset if they didn't receive your message? If yes, you should go ahead and send your email.



Sending

- Stay relevant. What was your lead interested in? Did they download your “5 Tips for Using QuickBooks to Manage Your Business” ebook? Or did they read your blog article on “How to Get Your Business Listed in Google Places”? Send them an email with more resources targeted to their interests.
- Get personal. Use a name and email address in the “from” line of your email that your recipients will recognize. Personalize the message so the recipient remembers how and why they came to your website. For example, start with “You recently checked out our ebook...” or “Thanks for subscribing to our blog!”
- WIIFM? At the end of the day, make sure that your message adds value. Get into the mind of your recipient and ask, “What’s In It For Me?” (WIIFM) Are you emailing them just to tell them how great your product is? Or are you offering to help solve a problem they’re facing? Make the value clear in both the email body and the subject line.
- Don’t rely on images. Many email clients don’t load images automatically, so if your email is one large image, your recipient won’t have any idea what it’s about! Use images as supplementary (clickable) content in your email, and make sure you have enough text to communicate value.
- Be consistent. You want your recipients to expect and look forward to your messages. Whether you send your messages daily, weekly, or monthly, pick a schedule and stick to it.
- Don’t let the law get you down. Brush up on CAN-SPAM regulations to make sure your email practices comply.

Converting

- What do I do here? When someone opens your email, make it clear what they’re supposed to do. Is it to click to read a blog article? Download a new, free ebook? Include a call-to-action that links to a landing page where the recipient can convert again and self-select to further engage with you.



- The landing page is part of your email campaign. Email marketing doesn't stop with a click. Your landing page is an extension of your email, and it is where your conversion takes place. Make sure your email offer and landing page flow, and review Chapter 5 of this ebook for tips on conversion opportunities and landing page best practices.

Measuring

- Click-Through Rate (CTR) measures response. Of the people you emailed, how many of them clicked through to your landing page? The CTR can give you a sense of how compelling your offer and email messages are. Experiment with different subject lines, calls-to-action, and timing to improve the CTR of your emails.
- What about open rate? Open rate is an increasingly unreliable metric, as more email clients do not load the images necessary for tracking who opened an email. Focus instead on how many clicks your email received.
- Unsubscribe rate measures annoyance and spam. There will always be some people who do not want to receive your emails anymore, but you want to make sure your unsubscribe rate does not exceed 5%. If your unsubscribe rate gets this high, check on your opt-in policies and procedures to make sure you're only emailing subscribers who want to receive your messages.
- Conversion rate measures actions. The final step is conversion, so measure how many of those clicks turned into reconversions on your landing page. Test different landing pages to improve the conversion on your website. Lead nurturing is all about developing relationships with your leads, so keep in mind that this does not have to be limited to email communication. Think about how you can communicate with your leads via social media or another platform they use.



7

Being Mobile-Friendly



It's obvious that mobile platforms are becoming more and more of a consideration when it comes to internet marketing. The growth of the iPhone is going to continue, with reports showing that Verizon may sell as many as 13 million iPhones in 2011. If you are trying to market on the mobile web, you need to consider the importance of creating entertaining and quality content that can be easily consumed on mobile devices such as smartphones or tablet computers.

Optimize for Mobile

Mobile marketing is being tossed around frequently in marketing circles, often with many different intended meanings. While mobile marketing can mean many things, there is one primary message being conveyed for marketers looking to take advantage of mobile: optimize for mobile devices.

While developing a mobile application relative to your business is another option, most businesses are still just ramping up their internet marketing efforts and do not have enough content to support a mobile application. Additionally, many marketers would be better off optimizing their SEO, email, lead nurturing, and social media campaigns for maximum lead generation before taking on yet another major project such as a mobile application.

For those internet marketers just getting started with mobile, the important thing to focus on is making sure your website is easy to view and navigate when accessed on mobile devices.

What should you worry about when optimizing for mobile?

1. Emails & Calls-to-Action

It is important that you optimize your website and emails to be viewed correctly on mobile devices, such as the iPhone and Android-powered devices. Additionally, it will be important to think about how your calls-to-action and offers work on mobile devices.



2. Downloads

Is it easy for a prospect to fill out a form on your website from their smartphone? If you are offering a download, will it open on mobile devices?

3. Video

Bytemobile has found that in 2011, 60 percent of all traffic on mobile web devices will be for video. The study also shows that 10 percent of mobile web users account for 90 percent of mobile web traffic. This staggering statistic means that a relatively small group of mobile internet users are doing the vast majority of mobile bandwidth consumption.

This data highlights some critical elements in the evolution of the mobile web. With indications that mobile bandwidth cost may be on the rise, it is important for marketers to develop lightweight ways to engage mobile users. Don't ask a user to stream a 10-minute video. Instead, provide a clean text summary of the video if they are using a cellular data connection. Give them an opportunity to watch the video if they are on a WiFi connection, in an effort to help them conserve mobile bandwidth.



8

Analyzing & Refining Strategies



Now that you have all the right internet marketing strategies in place, it's time to make all of them as efficient as they can be. Your main goal in this step is to find the best way to use all the techniques we've already discussed to get found online and generate new customers.

5 Steps for Analyzing & Refining Internet Marketing Strategies

1. Implement an Analytics Program

In order to analyze, you need to have an analytics program in place. Google Analytics is a non-business based but free tool that helps analyze your website traffic.

2. Identify Opportunities

Figure out what you want to improve. Do you want more people coming to your blog? Do you want to convert more visitors on your home page into leads? Get into the mindset of constantly looking for new opportunities.

3. Set a Metric for Success

In almost all cases, your metric should be quantifiable and involve a set time frame. For example: "Increase X website leads over the next X days."

4. Refine

Analyze how your programs performed and make changes with the aim of achieving your marketing goals by doing less of what doesn't work and more of what works (and by modifying what doesn't work so that it works better).

5. Evaluate

Determine if you've met your success metric. If so, stick with your change. See what you could have done differently. Continue to monitor it to make sure the improvement has a long-term effect.



Metrics to Analyze

In order for your refinements to have a big impact, you need to monitor several key factors. Again, you'll need analytics software to do this.

Before diving into how to improve them, let's first discuss what the relevant metrics are. This is just a minimal list of what you should be monitoring.

Website Grade: How well optimized is your website overall? To find out, continue running your website through Website Grader. You can sign up for monthly updates on your grade via the Website Grader report.

Traffic: Overall, how many people are coming to your website?

Leads: How much of this traffic are you converting into leads (e.g. potential customers)?

Customers: How many sales did you close this month? Customer Acquisition Cost: How much are you investing to draw in each new customer?

New vs. Repeat Visitors: Of your overall traffic, how many visitors are returning to your site, and how many new people are finding you? Both types of visitors are good. Attracting new visitors means people are finding you through search. Attracting repeat visitors means you've given people good reason to come back to your site. The key is finding a balance.

Effectiveness by Channel: What promotional channels or referring sources are sending you the most traffic? Focus on long-term results, not short-term traffic spurts that you might get from news coverage or press releases.

Traffic by Keywords: Which keywords are drawing in the most visitors to your site?



Steps for Improvement

While you should try to reach long-term goals, there are shorter-term steps you can take to get there. The following are a few elements of your website you can refine in order to reach your broader goals:

Keywords: Try new keywords or variations of keywords to see if they better help your business in getting found. Since each page on your site can incorporate different keywords, there are multiple ways of doing this.

On-Page SEO: See if changing a simple on-page factor can help boost visits. Examples of on-page factors are page titles, meta description, and headings. As a simple test, try changing the page title of one of your web pages to see if you generate more traffic.

Conversions: Try new things with your conversion forms or landing pages. For example, try locating the conversion form more prominently on your web page.

Content Strategy: Determine which content is generating the most traffic. This could mean increasing your focus on that type of content, or refining your delivery of other content.

Social Media Promotions: Evaluate which social media channels are generating the most site visitors and leads. Again, you can focus on your successful social media platforms, and/or try improving your performance in less successful platforms.

Lead Nurturing: Maybe you're sending emails too frequently—or perhaps not frequently enough. Maybe the calls-to-action in your email are not appropriate for your audience. Always keep experimenting and testing.



Conclusion

At first, internet marketing might seem daunting. But by approaching each internet marketing tactic step by step, businesses can make internet marketing more manageable and start generating results. By reading this ebook, we hope you've gained an understanding of how internet marketing can improve your overall marketing plan and help you achieve business growth.

The Next Step

If you are interested in using Internet marketing to grow your business and generate leads, take advantage of our Free 30-day trial of HubSpot.

